

the electronic device completes when small electrodes are placed directly onto the skin, which, in turn, transmits the data.

Music box

A music box lets one simultaneously choreograph dance and compose music using interactive electronics and body communication. A professional dancer performs in the box, and as different parts of her body touch its surface, musical notes and patterns are created. The result of this direct interaction between movement and sound is a unique and compelling performance.

Magic board

The magic board concept features similar functionalities to control PCs, laptops, netbooks and other devices through an interactive touch-screen surface. This innovative concept frees the user from using traditional keyboard or mouse by providing a gesture control surface where touching and moving fingers will do it all. This sleek and thin control board can be carried and used anywhere conveniently.

Skinput

Who knew tapping on the skin of your hands and arm could send readable signals to electronic devices? The breakthrough is called Skinput, and it could change the way you interact with small touchscreen devices. Skinput's researchers have shown that it can allow users to simply tap their skin to control audio devices, play games, make phone calls and navigate hierarchical browsing systems.

In Skinput, a keyboard, menu or other graphics are beamed onto the user's palm and forearm from a pico-projector embedded in an armband. An acoustic detector in the armband then determines which part of the display is activated by the user's touch.

As the researchers explain, variations in bone density, size and mass, as well as filtering effects from soft



Panasonic interactive whiteboard gives schools a head start

tissues and joints, mean different skin locations are acoustically distinct. Their software matches sound frequencies to specific skin locations, allowing the system to determine which 'skin button' the user pressed. For example, you can readily flick each of your fingers, touch the tip of your nose and clap your hands together without visual assistance. Few external input devices can claim this accurate, eyes-free input characteristic and provide such a large interaction area.

Multimedia in the classroom

Multimedia concept in education has gained much momentum. It's the integration of voice, data and video resources to create synergistic effect. The emergence of this concept of media convergence is also changing the curriculum in universities all over the world. In such a scenario, interactive whiteboards or electronic whiteboards are emerging as one of the powerful pedagogical innovations in the teaching and learning process. There are many potential benefits of interactive whiteboards for teaching, including flexibility and versatility, multimedia/multimodal presentation, efficiency-supporting planning and development

of resources, modelling of ICT skills, interactivity and participation in lessons.

Interactive toys

According to toy industry analysts, sales of traditional dolls have taken a dip, largely because young girls are becoming increasingly sophisticated in their play tastes and craving the stimulation offered by interactive, digitally driven toy concepts. A new doll concept looks set to answer this unmet need, blending computerised, state-of-the-art toy designs with the joy of imaginary play to create the world's first ever fully interactive fashion doll.

Companies are working to revolutionise the way children interact with their toys, creating a whole new category of play and entertainment. With advanced interactive technology, girls can watch their dolls actually come alive on their handheld digital screen or TV. Such a technology signals a new hybrid in the toy industry and the future in interactive play that provides an unprecedented visual and emotional experience with toys.

Future video games

Electronic games involve interaction with a user interface to generate visual feedback on a video device. Electronic